

Reasoning & Assumptions

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

"Three students who used the new study room earned higher grades, so the room raises grades for every student."

Task: What is the main flaw?

- A. The conclusion generalizes from a very small sample.
- B. Grades cannot be measured.
- C. Study rooms never help anyone.
- D. The statement contains no conclusion.

Exercise 2

"The café should stay open later because the gym is busy at night."

Task: What assumption does this argument depend on?

- A. Gym users are likely to want café service at that time.
- B. The café has chairs.
- C. Night comes after day.
- D. All gym users drink coffee.

Exercise 3

After a company changed its logo, sales increased. A manager says the new logo caused the increase.

Task: What evidence would most weaken the reasoning?

- A. A major discount campaign began the same week.
- B. The logo contains blue.
- C. The company sells several products.
- D. Sales are counted monthly.

Exercise 4

"A restaurant uses reservations, so a hospital emergency room should also schedule every patient to eliminate waiting."

Task: What is wrong with the comparison?

- A. Emergency cases are less predictable than restaurant arrivals.
- B. Restaurants and hospitals both have doors.
- C. Reservations are always bad.
- D. Hospitals never schedule appointments.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. The conclusion generalizes from a very small sample.

Why: Three students are not enough to justify a claim about every student.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. Gym users are likely to want café service at that time.

Why: Without a connection between nighttime gym users and café demand, the reasoning does not support later hours.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. A major discount campaign began the same week.

Why: It offers a plausible alternative cause for the sales increase.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Emergency cases are less predictable than restaurant arrivals.

Why: The argument ignores a difference that matters directly to whether reservations can control waiting.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.